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Strategy. Risk. Cyber. AI.




# Mapping every risk across a $9.7B credit union, then cutting the critical ones by 97%

A top-25 US credit union engaged Sthiros to run an enterprise-wide IT risk assessment, surfacing 1,124 risks across its technology ecosystem and cutting critical exposure by 97%.

| Client | Service | Sector | Geography |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Top-25 US Credit Union** | **Enterprise-Wide IT Risk Assessment** | **BFSI, Credit Union** | **United States** |

## The Challenge:

### When growth outpaces the risk you can see

The client manages $9.7B in assets and 460,000+ members nationwide, with 9 critical applications, 12 hardware categories, and 5 cloud platforms. IT risk was assessed system by system, never as one picture. Auditor findings sat open. The NCUA exam clock was running.

**Fragmented Risk View**
No consolidated picture across 9 apps, 12 hardware types, 5 cloud platforms.

**Unresolved Findings**
Open external auditor gaps sat unaddressed ahead of the next exam cycle.

**Access & SoD Gaps**
Access and notification controls left unvalidated across core systems.

**Vendor Blind Spots**
SLA gaps and thin monitoring across cloud and outsourced providers.

**No Evidence Trail**
Risk was assumed, not tested, with no owner or timeline attached.

**Exam Risk at Scale**
Growth without matching governance is an NCUA examination liability.

Expanding nationally while carrying unquantified IT risk is not a growth strategy. It is a liability. Evidence, not assumption, is what the next exam cycle demands.

## The Solution:

### One consolidated risk register, replacing assumption with evidence

Sthiros ran a structured enterprise-wide risk assessment across hardware, facilities, cloud, business processes, and applications, replacing fragmented, system-by-system views with one consolidated risk register.

Every risk was scored inherent to residual, mapped to existing controls, and assigned a named owner with a committed test frequency and deadline.

A near-$10 billion institution needed more than an audit It needed one system to tell inherent risk from residual risk, and hand every finding to a named owner with a deadline.

## The Methodology

### 1 Team Onboarding & Access

Access and onboarding secured across every in-scope system before assessment began.

### 2 Risk Register Template Design

A structured register built to hold inherent and residual scoring consistently across all three phases.

### 3 Baseline Checklist Development

Application- and process-specific checklists developed for every asset in scope.

### 4 Documentation Review

Process manuals, architecture diagrams, data flow diagrams, contracts, and past audit reports checked against actual practice.

### 5 Stakeholder Walkthroughs

137 interviews across asset managers, application owners, process owners, and IT teams validated what was on paper.

### 6 Draft Risk Register with Scoring

Impact multiplied by likelihood scored inherent risk; mapped controls determined what remained.

### 7 Review & Stakeholder Validation

Findings tested back against stakeholders before anything was finalised.

### 8 Final Risk Register Delivery

A fully documented, owner-assigned, ETA-committed register handed to management.

## What This Means

**Map risk before the auditor does.**

**Controls turn critical into rare.**

**Ownership beats a good register.**

## Outcomes

97%

**Critical risk reduction**

111 critical inherent risks cut to 3 residual through systematic control validation.

1,124

**Risks assessed**

Across every layer: hardware, facilities, cloud platforms, applications.

137

**Stakeholder interviews**

Validating real operating controls, not documented policy alone.

100%

**Audit-ready evidence**

Every finding logged with a named owner, control, and committed ETA.

## Get in touch

**Is your enterprise still assuming, or validating?**

Speak to Sthiros about what a structured risk assessment can unlock for your technology ecosystem.

Connect with us:
sthiros.com

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